



What's up doc?

Who needs shots when you have an in-built doctor to give em to you on the go? Say hello to the injection implant

Camera Phones



		
Samsung	LG	Apple
Galaxy Zoom	G2	iPhone 5
29,900	40,489	45,900
13.88	12.88	11.42
28.12	30.3	31.26
18.15	19.2	19.95
3.5	3.75	3.75
4.3	4.1	4
67.95	70.23	70.38
69.4	64.4	57.1
16	13	8
1/2.3	1/3	1/3
BSI CMOS	BSI CMOS	BSI CMOS
Samsung Brand	LG Brand	Apple Brand
24-240mm	29mm	33mm
Yes	Yes	No
Yes	No	No
f/3.1-6.3	f/2.4	f/2.4
0.7 seconds	0.5 seconds	0.5 seconds
2330mAh	3000mAh	1440 mAh
Yes	Yes	Yes
AMOLED	True HD+IPS	LED Backlit IPS
208	143	112
6	7	8
8	8	7
9	9	8
9	9	8
8	7	8
8	7	8
7.5	8	7.5
7	7.5	8
6	7	7
7	8	9
7	8	9
7	7.5	7.5
8	8	8
6	6	8
7.5	8	8
7	7	7.5
6.5	7	7
6	7	7
6	7	7
6	7	7
6	6	6
5	5	5
6	6	6
6	6	7

A few extra considerations

Obviously, the primary function of any camera is to take images, the cellphone adds a new layer to the experience by adding post processing capabilities to the process. While all phones and their built-in camera apps offer some level of editing capabilities such as cropping, straightening etc., enthusiasts might want a little extra.

It is in this regard that we felt that the iPhone 5 was at the highest advantage, leveraging the hundreds of editing apps available on the App store. Our favourite happens to be Snapseed, which offers not just a lot of editing styles, but also a great level of control. Then there is also Mextures that adds layers into editing, allowing users to apply various effects in varying degrees, all at once. The Android phones do enjoy a similar lavishness when it comes to editing apps, Snapseed being one (since it is now owned by Google) along with many others. The Lumias, unfortunately, suffer from a distinct lack of quality editing apps. While you will find plenty that give you the option of adjusting the basics, and even applying some effects, none of them are actually quite as polished as the iOS and Android apps.

Then there is the question of HDR and panorama apps. While the stock cameras on almost all phones now come with this feature, there is seldom the option of tweaking settings. When it comes to shooting HDR, all three platforms offer excellent choices but if you were to shoot in HDR with the Lumia 1020, you wouldn't expect it to weigh 38 megapixels. Apps built with the new SDK are yet to populate the Windows phone store.

For panoramas, the stock apps are, good, but the MS Photosynth app, available for iOS and Windows phone is one of our favourites. The optics on all the camera phones are excellent for daytime shooting of panoramas, however, if you were looking at taking nighttime panos, the Lumia 1020 would be your best choice. The camera grip accessory makes it compatible with any standard tripod, allowing you to shoot with it whenever, wherever.

Conclusion

It's incredibly tough to pick winners from this basket of eight phones, if we were to look at it subjectively. Our test was designed for mostly higher end cameras, but seeing how the new age cellphone cameras seek to uproot the point and shoot as your trusted daily companion, we felt it only fitting that these phones be subjected to the same rigors.

Looking at pure performance scores, the Lumia 1020 comes out ahead of the rest by quite a noticeable margin. It has a large sensor and an incredibly high pixel density when it comes to picture quality, but factor in startup times and time between shots, and it loses a few points. In terms of pure image and video quality, the Lumia 1020 is absolutely the king, but the slow performance of the Pro Cam app can be slightly annoying while using this otherwise great phone. However, no app would give the kind of extensive control Pro Cam can give you on any of the Lumia phones, with the 1020 being the most suited for the app. With Pro Cam, the Lumia 1020 can shoot images with the maximum resolution of 38 megapixels and creatively reframe the photograph later if needed. It offers lossless digital